

My Claude Usage Strategy

Student • Daily user • Coding, Content Creation, Learning, Research, Resume Building, Career Prep, Business Planning • Needs: Fast Answers, Creative Work, Coding Help, Learning Support, Deep Research, Business Strategy

RECOMMENDED PRIMARY MODEL: Claude Sonnet 5

Sonnet 5 is Anthropic's daily-driver model — strong at coding, writing, analysis, and research, efficient on rate limits, and capable enough for most professional and academic work. It covers your broad task mix without wasting your usage limit.

MODEL ROLES

Haiku 4.5 — Speed Quick facts, definitions, summaries, formatting, grammar fixes, simple resume edits. Note: older knowledge cutoff, avoid for recent topics.	Sonnet 5 — Daily Driver Coding & debugging, essays/blog drafts, tutoring-style explanations, standard research, resume/cover letter drafts, business planning.	Opus 4.8 — Hard Problems Complex code/architecture, deep multi-source research, final polish on high-stakes docs, business strategy with many variables.
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EFFORT LEVELS

Low — quick lookups, simple rewrites | **Standard (default)** — everyday coding, writing, learning | **High** — multi-step reasoning: research summaries, business outlines | **Max** — hardest problems only: final projects, full business plans, deep research

MY PERSONALIZED WORKFLOW

Task	Model	Effort	Reason
Quick facts / definitions	Haiku 4.5	Low	Fast, cheap for simple lookups
Daily coding / debugging	Sonnet 5	Standard	Efficient, strong coding support
Hard coding (architecture/refactors)	Opus 4.8	High/Max	Needs deeper reasoning
Content creation (blogs, posts)	Sonnet 5	Standard	Strong writing + creativity
Learning support / tutoring	Sonnet 5	Standard	Clear explanations, no overkill
Deep research (multi-source)	Opus 4.8	High/Max	Careful synthesis across sources
Resume — first draft	Sonnet 5	Standard	Solid drafting quality
Resume — final polish	Opus 4.8	High	High-stakes, worth extra reasoning
Career prep (interviews, cover letters)	Sonnet 5	Standard	Good for most cases
Business planning (brainstorm)	Sonnet 5	Standard	Good ideation & structure
Business strategy (financial/market logic)	Opus 4.8	High/Max	Complex multi-variable reasoning
Fast factual answers	Haiku 4.5	Low	Speed over depth

BIGGEST MISTAKES TO AVOID

- Using Opus for everything — burns through your rate limit fast.
- Using Haiku for research or current-events topics — stale knowledge cutoff.
- Defaulting to Max effort always — slower and usually unnecessary.
- Not escalating to Opus when Sonnet visibly struggles on a hard problem twice.
- Treating resumes/business docs as casual — they're high-stakes, use Opus + High effort.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION: If you could use only ONE model + ONE effort level — Claude Sonnet 5 at Standard effort. It covers ~80–90% of your daily needs (coding, writing, learning, resumes, planning) efficiently. Save Opus 4.8 at High/Max for your hardest research, code, and career/business documents.